

Ricard Gardella

AI Engineer & Cybersecurity Specialist

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SUMMARY

Senior AI engineer with 10+ years building intelligent, secure, data-driven systems across fintech, crypto, cybersecurity, retail, and logistics. Ships LLM-powered applications in production and breaks them on weekends through bug bounties and CTF.

EXPERIENCE

Senior AI Engineer · Checktrade

Apr 2026 — Present

London, UK (Remote)

- Building AI-powered features for the UK's leading home-improvement platform — LLMs, RAG, MCP, A2A, ADK, and multi-agent workflows in production.

Stack: Python · AWS · GCP · LLMs · RAG · MCP · A2A · ADK · Terraform · Kubernetes · Docker · CI/CD · Datadog

Lead AI Engineer, Cybersecurity · Zynap

Oct 2024 — May 2026

Barcelona, Spain (Hybrid)

- Joined as an early hire and built Zynap's AI and Data functions from zero.
- Designed and shipped **NINA AI** — multi-agent conversational co-pilot for security engineers and SOC analysts (workflow automation, diagnostics, threat intel, malware analysis).
- Built ingestion platform processing **1B+ records/month** ensuring preemptive threat detection.
- Migrated critical query path from MongoDB to Elasticsearch — **67.5% faster** queries.
- Built Dark Web threat-intelligence pipeline spanning **5+ sources**.

Stack: Python · FastAPI · Go · LLMs · LangGraph · Elasticsearch · Terraform · Kubernetes · Docker · GCP · AWS

Senior Data Engineer · Bitpanda

Feb 2023 — Nov 2024

Barcelona, Spain (Hybrid)

- Led end-to-end design and implementation of Bitpanda's data platform, supporting **4M+ daily transactions**.
- Built **50+ ingestion jobs** (hourly/daily) feeding the data lake from internal and external sources.
- Rolled out dbt across **4 product teams**, decentralising data ownership. After the initial rollout, dbt has been adopted by the entire company **15+ teams**.
- Mentored **3+** engineers and managed interns.

Stack: Snowflake · dbt · Airflow · Kafka · Python · AWS · Terraform · Astronomer · Datadog · Gitlab · Iceberg

Data Engineer & Tech Lead · Inditex

Aug 2022 — Feb 2023

Barcelona, Spain (Remote)

- Designed data models for the Sustainability division — ESG reporting consumed by leadership and regulators across the world's largest fashion group.
- Built **50+ data objects** with millions of records, impacting **5+ teams**.
- Improved CI/CD pipelines, reducing deployment time and cost by **20%**.
- Tech-lead role across standards, code review, and engineer onboarding. Technical mentor for **5+** engineers.

Stack: Snowflake · Azure · Azure SQL · SQL · Tech Lead · Github · Docker

Data Engineer · Goin

Jan 2021 — Jul 2022

Barcelona, Spain (Hybrid)

- Built data pipelines and the recommendation API powering personalised financial insights for **500K+ active users**.
- Built the data platform end-to-end, including **100+** KPI dashboards.

Stack: Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · GCP · Docker · Github · Datadog · Terraform · Kubernetes · CI/CD

Head of Data · Delivery Mates

Sep 2019 — Jan 2021

London, UK (Remote)

- Built the entire data function **0→1** for a fast-growing UK last-mile logistics startup — pipelines, warehouse, reporting, analytics from scratch.

Stack: Airflow · Python · 0→1 · Team Building · Superset · Metabase · Tableau · PowerBI

SKILLS

Languages	Python · SQL · Go · TypeScript · Bash
AI / ML	LLMs · RAG · Multi-agent systems · LangChain · LangGraph · OpenAI · Anthropic · Local LLM deployment · Vector DBs · ADK · A2A · MCP · MLOps
Data	Snowflake · dbt · Airflow · Kafka · Spark · Elasticsearch · PostgreSQL · MongoDB · Redshift · Astronomer
Cloud / Infra	AWS · GCP · Azure · Terraform · Docker · Kubernetes · CI/CD · Digger
Security	AI Red Teaming · Bug Bounty · Threat Intel · OSINT · CTF · Web Exploitation

EDUCATION

M.Sc. in Innovation and Research in Informatics (MIRI), Data Science specialty Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya (UPC) <i>Thesis: Travel-time forecasting using probe-vehicle data on freeways — Grade 9.5/10.</i>	2017 — 2019
BSc Computer Engineering Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya	2013 — 2017

CERTIFICATIONS

- HTB Certified Web Exploitation Specialist — Hack The Box (Apr 2026)
- Databricks Lakehouse Fundamentals — Databricks (Dec 2022)
- Big Data Analytics — Barcelona Supercomputing Center (Feb 2019)
- Applied Machine Learning in Python — Coursera / U. Michigan (Jul 2018)
- Cambridge Certificate in Advanced English (CAE) — Cambridge Assessment English

NOTABLE

- Hall of Fame — VDP & Bug Bounty — [NASA VDP \(x2\)](#), [U.S. Dept. of Commerce \(x1\)](#), [U.S. Dept. of Energy \(x1\)](#).
- Fraunhofer Institute Prize — HackCorona (2020), AI Ventilator Assistant chatbot.
- Best Data Science Project — HackEPS 2018, ML solution for BonÀrea retail challenge.

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · Catalan (native) · English (C1 / CAE) · Japanese (basic)